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Lynne Parker, PhD
Executive Director, President's Council of Advisors on Science and Technology
White House Office of Science and Technology
Office of Science and Technology Policy
Eisenhower Executive Office Building
1650 Pennsylvania Avenue, NW
Washington, DC 20504

Submitted electronically via email to [REDACTED]

RE: Request for Information on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

Dear Dr. Parker,

We appreciate the opportunity to provide input on the federal government's approach to artificial intelligence (AI) policy. We commend the administration's commitment to ensuring American leadership in AI development, fostering innovation, and advancing the potential of AI-driven breakthroughs across industries, including healthcare.

City of Hope (COH) is one of America's largest and most advanced cancer research and treatment organizations and is also a leading research center for diabetes and other life-threatening illnesses. Founded in 1913, City of Hope has an independent, National Cancer Institute-designated comprehensive cancer center that is ranked in the top 5 in the nation for cancer care by *U.S. News & World Report*. Our growing national system includes the Los Angeles campus with extensive facilities for patient care, research, and academic training; a network of clinical care locations of clinical care locations across Southern California; a new cancer center in Orange County, California; and cancer treatment centers and outpatient facilities in the Atlanta, Chicago, and Phoenix areas. The Arizona-based Translational Genomics Research Institute, a world-renowned genomics research institute, is also part of the COH organization.

COH's mission is to make hope a reality for all touched by cancer and diabetes. More than 86 million people now live in communities with local access to a COH location. Last year, our organization treated close to 160,000 patients. As a leading independent biomedical research institution and cancer treatment center, COH is dedicated to leveraging cutting-edge technologies to improve cancer care and expand access to lifesaving treatments.

COH's innovative use of artificial intelligence is transforming patient care and research. Since 2017, we have been developing, deploying, and optimizing life-saving AI-driven predictive models that are actively integrated into clinical workflows. These models help identify critical risks—such as sepsis in vulnerable populations and complications in surgical procedures—enabling timely interventions that enhance clinical outcomes and improve quality of life. Our pioneering AI initiatives extend to oncology drug discovery, early cancer detection and prevention, advanced diagnostics, and deeper insights into cancer evolution and disease progression. Additionally, our oncology-specific large language model

platform, powered by COH's unique data assets and world-class subject matter expertise, is streamlining administrative tasks and empowering clinicians with accurate, actionable, real-time data. These innovations provide clinicians with unique AI-driven insights that enhance decision-making in diagnosis and treatment, ultimately improving the patient experience and quality of life. In doing so, COH remains at the forefront of technological innovation, ensuring that hope is delivered to every patient and community we serve.

AI is poised to transform oncology and healthcare, enabling more efficient research, earlier cancer detection, personalized treatment plans, and enhanced patient outcomes. To maximize AI's benefits while mitigating risks, it is essential that federal policies provide clear, practical guidelines that support innovation through ethical AI deployment while protecting patient safety, and data privacy.

COH recognizes and supports the administration's focus on removing barriers to AI development and ensuring the United States remains at the forefront of global AI leadership. Targeted, thoughtful regulatory approaches—rather than unnecessary constraints—will be the key to unlocking AI's full potential in healthcare. As policymakers consider the future of AI governance, COH welcomes the opportunity to collaborate in shaping policies that bolster American innovation, protect patient safety, and enable AI-driven advancements in medicine.

City of Hope's Internal Governance for AI

As an organization that both develops and uses AI tools in a highly regulated industry (healthcare) and a highly regulated state (California), COH strives to ensure that any AI tools we deploy have the seven characteristics of trustworthy AI systems as identified in the National Institute of Standards and Technology's (NIST) AI Risk Management Framework: (1) Valid and Reliable; (2) Safe; (3) Secure and Resilient; (4) Accountable and Transparent; (5) Explainable and Interpretable; (6) Privacy-Enhanced; and (7) Fair with Harmful Bias Managed.

We believe it is important for future federal policy to adhere to these principles and, to this end, we have built our own AI governance structure on the NIST principles. To ensure AI and Machine Learning (ML) is applied responsibly and ethically across our organization, we are working diligently to establish organizational policy that sets forth clear guidelines and best practices for team members engaged in development of AI/ML tools, in addition to those using AI/ML in their day-to-day work.

Our internal AI governance policy emphasizes the need to disclose current AI tools and submit future use cases for review. The policy identifies potential risks associated with AI/ML and generative AI, which include inaccuracies, biases, and intellectual property concerns. Employees are instructed to verify AI outputs, engage leadership for new AI adoptions, and avoid inputting personal or confidential information into public AI tools. The policy stresses compliance, outlining specific "do's" and "don'ts" to maintain safety, effectiveness, and ethical integrity. Ultimately, City of Hope aims to harness AI/ML's power while safeguarding patient care and privacy, research, and organizational standards.

AI Model Development and Governance

As federal agencies consider approaches to AI governance, it is important to recognize that AI applications present varying levels of risk depending on their context. Governance at both the federal and state levels would be best served by a risk-based approach tailored to how AI models are applied. While COH does not take a position on regulating foundation models, we offer insight from our experience deploying AI in clinical settings.

At COH, our work in predictive modeling for clinical decision support—such as post-bone marrow transplant risk-assessment and surgical complication prediction—has shown that achieving high initial accuracy is only the first step in responsible AI implementation. To ensure patient safety and model reliability, AI systems must undergo rigorous validation across diverse patient populations and clinical settings before deployment.

Federal policy should encourage frameworks that emphasize real-world testing, subgroup analyses, and continuous monitoring to detect drift and evolving clinical risks. This approach would help safeguard patient safety while fostering an environment that supports responsible medical innovation.

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Explainability and Assurance of AI Model Outputs

In healthcare, explainability is not just a technical nicety—it is fundamental to clinical decision-making. COH understands that when AI outputs are transparent and interpretable, clinicians can trust and effectively act on these insights to improve patient outcomes. For example, COH's predictive models provide risk scores along with contextual explanations that clarify the factors driving the prediction.

That said, explainable AI is a challenging and evolving field, without a clear resolution at this time. COH believes that policy should strike a balance between promoting robust standards for interpretability while retaining sufficient flexibility to accommodate emerging technologies. For instance, in contexts where full explainability may be unattainable—such as with large language model outputs—alternative assurance measures like providing supporting references, confidence scores, and verification tools should be encouraged.

Ultimately, the goal is to ensure that AI systems are safe, reliable, and trusted, while continuing to advance progress and innovation in the healthcare field.

Application and Use (Private Sector or Government)

At COH, we believe that responsible and well-integrated AI applications can significantly improve research, patient care, and operational efficiency. Policies should encourage partnerships between public institutions and private enterprises to scale these innovations, providing clear frameworks for deployment, risk management, and continuous monitoring, while remaining adaptive enough to support innovative approaches.

By fostering collaboration and focusing governance on the application and use of AI, policymakers can help ensure that AI tools are safely, responsibly, and effectively implemented to enable research, enhance patient outcomes, streamline operations, and ultimately drive meaningful progress in healthcare.

Research and Development

At COH, our pursuit of innovative AI research—from oncology-specific large language models to multi-modal systems for understanding cancer evolution and disease progression—illustrates the transformative power of robust AI research and development. Policies should prioritize and support interdisciplinary research and experimentation. We believe that breakthroughs in precision medicine and early disease detection and prevention can be achieved through funding initiatives, collaborative frameworks, and public–private partnerships that foster rapid prototyping and real-world testing. Importantly, regulatory measures must be designed to empower researchers without stifling innovation. Such an approach can accelerate the translation of cutting-edge research into practical, life-saving applications.

By bridging the gap between research and clinical application, appropriate AI policies can ensure that advances in AI are quickly and safely integrated into healthcare delivery, ultimately driving significant improvements in patient outcomes and operational efficiency.

Conclusion

COH remains committed to harnessing artificial intelligence to enhance patient care, advance research, and improve healthcare efficiency, while upholding the highest ethical and regulatory standards. AI holds tremendous potential to drive breakthroughs in precision medicine, early disease detection, and operational efficiency, but realizing this potential requires thoughtful governance that balances innovation, safety, and trust.

A risk-based, application-focused approach to AI policy will be essential to ensuring that AI-driven advancements in healthcare remain safe, transparent, and effective. Explainability, validation, and continuous monitoring must be prioritized, while policies should remain adaptive enough to support emerging technologies and interdisciplinary research. Encouraging public–private partnerships and funding initiatives will help accelerate the responsible deployment of AI in clinical settings.

COH welcomes continued engagement with federal policymakers to help shape AI governance in a way that fosters innovation while safeguarding patient well-being. By prioritizing transparency, rigorous oversight, and collaboration, policymakers can help ensure that AI remains a trusted and transformative tool in healthcare, improving outcomes for patients and communities alike.

Sincerely,

Simon Nazarian
Executive Vice President, Chief Digital and Technology Officer

Harlan Levine, MD
President, Health Innovation and Policy